

Product Review

OVERVIEW

Product name: ZORYVE (roflumistat cream) 0.15%

Category: Rx, topical prescription product

Vehicle/form: Cream

Skin or hair type: Suitable for diverse skin types.

Used for: Topical treatment of inflammation, redness, and itch associated with atopic dermatitis in adult and pediatric patients 6 years of age and older.

Black-owned business: No

Certified cruelty-free: No

Certified organic: No

Vegan: No



KEY FINDINGS



SAFETY

Low Risk

Generally safe. Product ingredients have low irritancy or allergy potential.



RESEARCH / DATA AVAILABLE

Fair

There is a fair amount of published data or documented usage in the Black community.

RECOMMENDATION: ZORYVE cream is a generally safe and effective prescription option for treating mild-to-moderate atopic dermatitis in individuals with Black skin. It offers a non-steroidal alternative that avoids pigment changes, which are a significant concern for people with darker skin tones. However, caution is advised for individuals who are sensitive to parabens or who have acne-prone skin, as some ingredients could cause irritation or clogged pores in susceptible users. Given only 20% of the long-term data was based on Black patients, we recommend following label instructions closely and consulting a healthcare provider if any irritation, worsening of symptoms, or lack of improvement occurs. For those who wish to avoid parabens entirely, discussing alternative treatments with a dermatologist may be advisable.

SUPPORTING DATA AND ANALYSIS

Key Area	Findings
Active ingredients	Roflumilast, PDE4 inhibitor. 1.5mg per gram of cream
Inactive ingredients	Cetareth-10 phosphate, cetearyl phosphate, cetostearyl alcohol, diethylene glycol monoethyl ether, hexylene glycol, isopropyl palmitate, methylparaben, propylparaben, purified water, sodium hydroxide, white petrolatum, and hydrochloric acid (may be added to adjust pH).

Formulation concerns	• ZORYVE cream contains parabens (methylparaben and propylparaben), which help preserve the product but may be a concern for people who prefer to avoid certain chemicals, even though they are allowed and safe in small amounts. • Isopropyl palmitate may clog pores in people who have acne-prone skin. • Some ingredients like cetareth-10 phosphate could cause mild irritation in individuals with very sensitive skin, although this is rare. • People with moderate to severe liver disease should not use this product because of how the active ingredient is processed in the body. • Overall, ZORYVE is considered safe for most people when used as directed, but it's wise to watch for any signs of irritation or reactions, especially during the first few uses.
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Research and ingredient analysis	• Roflumilast is the main ingredient and helps reduce skin inflammation and itching in eczema. • Fit for Black skin: study programs that included Black/African American participants and darker skin tones show meaningful improvement with once-daily use, with no treatment-related lightening or darkening reported. • Systemic absorption is low, so the risk of effects inside the body is minimal for most users. • Parabens are used as preservatives but have moderate safety concerns for some users who prefer to avoid them. • Overall, most people tolerate the cream well when it's used as prescribed, but users with sensitive skin should monitor for any irritation.
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Data sources to consider	• ZORYVE Official Prescribing Information (Arcutis) – https://www.arcutis.com/wp-content/uploads/USPI-roflumilast-cream.pdf • PubMed – https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/40130783 • Dermatology Times – https://www.dermatologytimes.com/view/positive-results-reported-in-roflumilast-0-15-for-ad-across-diverse-populations • PatientCare Online – https://www.patientcareonline.com/view/roflumilast-cream-0-15-well-tolerated-in-atopic-dermatitis-patients-with-prior-treatment-failures • DelveInsight Blog – https://www.delveinsight.com/blog/zoryve-for-atopic-dermatitis-treatment • EWG Skin Deep Database – https://www.ewg.org/skindeep/ • What's In My Jar (WIMJ) – https://whatsinmyjar.com • SkinSafe Products (Mayo Clinic) – https://www.skinsafeproducts.com • FDA MedWatch – https://www.fda.gov/safety/medwatch-fda-safety-information-and-adverse-event-reporting-program • INCIdocoder – https://incidecoder.com • Wikipedia (Roflumilast) – https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Roflumilast
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— See the legend on page 3 for a description of our scoring system. —

Last reviewed: July 2025

UNDERSTANDING YOUR RESULTS

WeSeeColor evaluates products by examining the ingredients listed on product labels and reviewing available scientific research and literature on both the products and their individual ingredients. Each product is rated on a 5-point scale, considering ingredient safety (and the potential for adverse reactions), the availability of data and research, and documented efficacy on Black skin and hair, when available.

SAFETY RATING

Very High Risk	High Risk	Moderate Risk	Low Risk	Very Low Risk
				
Caution. Strong likelihood that this product may cause irritation and/or an allergic reaction. Seek medical attention if exposed.	This product may cause irritation and/or an allergic reaction. Be careful and consult your physician.	In certain situations, this product may cause irritation or an allergic reaction. Speak with your physician to learn more.	Generally safe. Product ingredients have low irritancy or allergy potential.	Safe to use on most occasions. Product ingredients have negligible irritancy or allergy potential.

RESEARCH / DATA AVAILABILITY RATING

None	Limited	Fair	Good	Robust
				
There is no data on this product or ingredients used in the Black community.	There is limited published data on this product or ingredients used in the Black community.	There is a fair amount of published data or documented usage in the Black community.	Product or its ingredients have been studied extensively or used extensively in the Black community.	This product or its ingredients have been studied extensively, used extensively, and known in the Black community.

GENERAL CONSIDERATIONS

- Dietary supplements can have unexpected interactions with other products, drugs, or conditions. If the product is characterized as a dietary supplement, we recommend starting with a small intake and monitoring for potential side or adverse effects and consult with a licensed professional before resuming use.
- Allergens may sometimes be listed in labels using their scientific name (e.g. “arachis hypogaea oil” for “peanut oil”). Familiarize yourself with the scientific name of any ingredient to which you may be allergic and review the label carefully before starting usage.